STARTUP VENTURA · BRIEF FOR CITIES AND THE COUNTY

Fund seats for your founders. Get the outcomes reported back.

Startup Ventura
501(c)(3) public charity, founded 2025. EIN 39-2204612.
Candid Platinum Seal of Transparency, 2026.
Luke Erickson, Founder and Executive Director
luke@startupventura.com · info@startupventura.com
startupventura.com/partner-cities-county

The ask. Fund reserved seats in the Startup Ventura accelerator for founders from your jurisdiction, and receive a written outcomes report once a year. In 2025 the City of Ventura approved $49,500 for Startup Ventura through its Economic Development department. Amounts and terms are set per agency.

WHAT IT IS

A 12-week accelerator run in official partnership with Plug and Play. It is Plug and Play's first formal accelerator program in Ventura County and the launch point for its expanded Southern California focus. Free to founders: no tuition, no fees, no equity. Inaugural cohort Spring 2027: 5 to 10 companies, hybrid, one in-person day a week in Ventura County. Applications open January 2027. Plus a free workshop series and a Demo Day. Plug and Play operates 60+ locations across five continents and accelerates 2,500+ startups a year.

WHAT A PARTNERSHIP INCLUDES

- Reserved cohort seats for founders based in your city or district.
- A written outcomes report on the founders you funded, once a year.
- Recognition as a public partner on startupventura.com and in program materials.

WHAT YOU WILL BE ABLE TO MEASURE

Reported for every cohort, once a year, starting with the Spring 2027 cohort, to each public partner and on the Impact page:

- Founders served, by city of residence or company address.
- Companies launched or incorporated in Ventura County.
- Jobs at cohort companies, counted at graduation and at 12 months.
- Follow-on capital raised by cohort companies.
- Founders who remain in Ventura County after the program.

PUBLIC DOLLARS IN, AND WHAT THEY STAND ALONGSIDE

SOURCE	AMOUNT	STATUS
City of Ventura, Economic Development	$49,500	APPROVED, 2025
The Foundation of Ventura County Credit Union, community grant	$10,000	AWARDED, OCTOBER 2026
Annual Benefit, November 2025 (75 supporters)	$17,000	RAISED
National Science Foundation, Advanced Technological Education: Community Colleges of Ventura County Venture Creation Initiative. Lead applicant: Ventura County Community College District. Startup Ventura: subawardee.	up to $3,000,000	APPLIED FOR, NOT AWARDED

WHY HERE: PROOF AND NEED

THE TRADE DESK · FOUNDED IN VENTURA, 2009

S&P 500

joined the index in July 2025; still headquartered in Ventura

CURRI · FOUNDED IN DOWNTOWN VENTURA

$42M

Series B led by Bessemer Venture Partners, 2023; a Y Combinator company

VENTURA VENTURES TECHNOLOGY CENTER · OPENED 2009, NOW CLOSED

4

companies the City credits to its incubator: The Trade Desk, MomentFeed, Connexity, GiddyUp

The need. Job growth in 2025 was 0.0 percent, and since 2007 every net new job has come from education and health care. The population peaked at about 850,000 in 2016 and stood at 828,500 in 2025; net domestic out-migration reached 5,027 in 2025, up 17 percent, and those leaving are mostly under 40 with incomes of $50,000 to $150,000 a year. In the second quarter of 2026, 19 percent of households could afford the median-priced home.

Sources: Cal Lutheran Center for Economic Research and Forecasting, Ventura County Outlook and Forecast 2026 (February 2026); KCLU, February 25, 2026; California Association of Realtors, Housing Affordability Index, Q2 2026; S&P Dow Jones Indices, July 2025. Regional assets: Port of Hueneme, the only commercial deep water port between Los Angeles and San Francisco; Naval Base Ventura County, more than 19,000 military and civilian personnel (navy.mil); agriculture, $2.4 billion (2025 Crop and Livestock Report); Amgen global headquarters, Thousand Oaks.

WHO IS ALREADY AT THE TABLE

Supporting: City of Ventura, Ventura County Credit Union, Ventura Chamber of Commerce. **Educational:** Ventura County Community College District, Moorpark College, Oxnard College, Ventura College, CSU Channel Islands, Ventura Unified School District, Oak Park Unified School District. **Workforce and industry:** Workforce Development Board of Ventura County, Curri. **Program partner:** Plug and Play.

Board: Luke Erickson, Founder and Executive Director. Brent-Stig Kraus, former Chief Revenue Officer, SevenRooms (acquired by DoorDash). Brian Gonzalez, Co-Founder and CTO, Curri. Sean Herwaldt, Director at Curri, former Global Supply Manager at SpaceX.

GOVERNANCE AND RISK

- 501(c)(3) public charity founded 2025. EIN 39-2204612.
- Candid Platinum Seal of Transparency, 2026; the Candid profile lists board, programs and metrics.
- Plug and Play's standard format. No equity taken in any company. Founders pay nothing.
- Outcomes reported to every public partner once a year.
- Board operating experience at SevenRooms, Curri and SpaceX.

Next step: request a working session at startupventura.com/partner-cities-county or email luke@startupventura.com. We bring the numbers for your jurisdiction.

Version October 27, 2026.
Figures current as of October 2026. Grant applications shown are listed as applied for until an award is announced.